COURSE OUTLINE

PROGRAMME TITLE	**Dashboards Without Code Using Microsoft Power BI: From Data to Decisions**
OVERVIEW (brief introduction of the topic)	Organisations collect large amounts of data across finance, sales, operations, customer and people systems, yet many teams lack the skills to analyse it independently and turn it into decisions. The evidence shows why closing this gap matters: • According to DataCamp (2026), 60% of enterprise leaders report a data skills gap, yet only 42% provide foundational data literacy training at scale. • In fact, 76% of leaders say employees with strong data literacy outperform those without (DataCamp, 2026). • The World Economic Forum (2025) reports that 63% of employers identify skills gaps as the biggest barrier to business transformation, while 85% plan to prioritise workforce upskilling. • In Malaysia, Randstad's 2025 outlook found that 56% of employers cite a lack of skilled talent as their top hiring challenge (New Straits Times, 2024). **Data stored but not used as an asset** • According to SoftServe (2025), a survey of 750 leaders at companies with US$1 billion or more in revenue found that 65% believe no one in their organisation understands all the data collected and how to access it, and 60% struggle to access data when they need it for decisions. • Most of this stored data is unstructured (documents, emails, forms, scans): about 90% of enterprise data, yet only 26% of organisations analyse their content using mostly automated methods (IDC, as cited in Box, 2023). • In fact, only 58% of unstructured data is reused after it is first created (RecordPoint, 2025), so data sits in storage as a cost rather than working as an asset. **Messy data, heavy paperwork and weak governance** • RecordPoint (2025) reports that 84% of respondents lacked governance over data, privacy and security, and an IDC survey found that 22% of IT decision-makers say unstructured data is needlessly duplicated because organisations do not know what they have (IDC, as cited in RecordPoint, 2025). **Biased or inaccurate data, and the impact on decisions** • SoftServe (2025) found that 58% of leaders say key business decisions are based on inaccurate or inconsistent data most of the time, if not always, and 73% say their data strategy needs major updates or a complete overhaul.

	• According to Progress (2023), 65% of executives believe data bias exists in their organisation, yet only 13% address it through an ongoing evaluation process. When only the neat, structured part of the data is analysed, the picture can be skewed without anyone noticing. **Why Power BI is a useful tool for closing this gap** • Power BI lets non-technical staff connect to many data sources, clean and shape the data with no-code tools, build visuals and share dashboards from one platform (Microsoft, n.d.), turning stored data into a governed, decision-ready view. • Microsoft Power BI was also recognised as a Leader in the Forrester Wave for Business Intelligence Platforms, Q2 2025, with the highest score of any vendor in generative AI functionality (Microsoft Power BI Team, 2025c). This hands-on programme shows professionals from any function how to turn everyday data into a simple, management-ready dashboard, with no coding or prior analytics experience. Using a running case study, participants practise moving from receiving reports to accessing, monitoring, analysing, interpreting and recommending action from their own data, turning messy, stored data into a trusted asset for decisions.
LEARNING OUTCOME	By the end of the programme, participants will be able to: • Identify and define the key metrics that matter for their role or business • Prepare and structure data from multiple sources for analysis • Explain why Power BI is a suitable tool for no-code, management-ready dashboards compared with spreadsheets, other BI platforms and custom-built applications • Build a simple, interactive dashboard using Microsoft Power BI, with no code • Interpret trends to distinguish genuine issues from noise or misleading numbers • Present insights and recommendations to management with confidence, backed by evidence. • Handle data responsibly, with due regard for confidentiality and data protection
DURATION (days)	0.5 day (4 hours, 240 minutes)
TARGET PARTICIPANTS (position/level)	• Executives and officers in business functions (operations, finance, sales, marketing, HR) • Team leaders, supervisors and managers who need to interpret data • Business and project coordinators • Administrative professionals who handle reports and data • Entrepreneurs and SME owners • Anyone moving toward a more data-driven role

	Prerequisite: no coding or analytics background required; basic Excel familiarity is helpful. Participants need a work or school (company) email to sign in to Power BI Service, and free Miro and Canva accounts should be ready before the session.
COURSE CONTENT (with submodules)	**Module 1: Identify Data for Better Decisions (35 min)** • **Submodule 1: The Lego Challenge** for gamified opener: turn a pile of messy coloured bricks into a structured house (messy data to structured data to a dashboard that tells the story) • **Submodule 2: The data gap**: why having data is not the same as being data-driven, and how to move from data chaos to data value • **Submodule 3: Choosing the right metrics and KPIs**, the "Big Why", mapping your data to the decisions it supports, and brainstorming metrics for your role, team or business together on tools platform (e.g Miro or Whiteboard) • **Submodule 4: Why Power BI?** – a no-code comparison of Power BI with Excel PivotTables (quick, personal analysis), Tableau (visualisation-led exploration) and custom web apps (highly tailored products). According to Microsoft (n.d.), Power BI brings connecting, cleaning, modelling, visualising and sharing data into one workflow. **Module 2: Preparing Data for Analysis (40 min)** • **Submodule 1: Finding and combining data** – bringing data from spreadsheets, systems and reports together using no-code tools in Power BI Service / Desktop • **Submodule 2: Cleaning and structuring data** – removing duplicates, and handling missing fields and unknown values, with no-code tools in Power BI Service/ Desktop • **Submodule 3: Data protection and quality checklist** – spotting duplicates, missing fields, unknown values and data bias, plus governance **Module 3: Building Your Dashboard Without Code (65 min)** • **Submodule 1: Dashboard design principles** – right chart, right analysis and right questions • **Submodule 2: Building KPI cards and trend charts** – hands-on build in Power BI Service • **Submodule 3: Breakdowns, filters and slicers** with making the dashboard interactive for different audiences and questions • **Submodule 4: Interface design** using Canva and free button and interface templates • **Submodule 5: Running use cases with synthetic data** building an HR Analytics Dashboard or Turning Sales Data into Revenue Decisions or etc. **Module 4: Interpreting and Presenting Insights (70 min)** • **Submodule 1: Reading trends**; separating real problems from noise and misleading numbers

	• **Submodule 2: Data storytelling**, focus on structuring one evidence-based recommendation for management • **Submodule 3: Capstone presentation** with present your dashboard and one evidence-based recommendation, with peer feedback • **Submodule 4: Back-to-work action plan** with drafting personal next steps on Microsoft Learn Power BI learning paths and encourage to take certification. • **Submodule 5: Programme wrap-up** with questions, key takeaways and feedback (Online Forms).
LEARNING METHODOLOGIES	Interactive and experiential learning with lecture, group discussion, case work, a gamified Lego challenge and hands-on dashboard-building exercises.

References

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